

Invariably Abandoned

LED Status Panel



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04 Feb 2026 • 1 min read

I recently completed adding slightly over 10m of LED strips to act as ambient and party lights in one of the rooms of our apartment.

I was left with somewhere around 1m of SK6812 strip and thought about some good use for them. I came up with the idea of a physical status panel about the state of home automations or home lab services etc.

Dashboards are all well and good but there is something more tactile about having panels with blinking lights.

I found <https://cdn-learn.adafruit.com/downloads/pdf/neopixels-on-raspberry-pi.pdf> which takes you through controller adafruit neopixels with raspberry pi gpio pins.

Housing

Rough Sketch

First Prototypes

It took four prototypes to get something where the strip fit snugly, with the correct spacing and with a reasonable amount of print imperfections on the bridging. These were printed on my Prusa Mk4 with a pretty aggressive speed and with a filament that I don't like and am trying to use up.

First RC

The first release candidate for the housing I printed quite slow in order to get the best results for the bridging, and at the final target size with my preferred filament for labels (Das Filament Tonweiss Matte).

Electronics

The hardware

- 6LEDs worth (or more) of SK6812
- A leftover raspberry pi 1 from a draw somewhere
- USB power for the pi
- A cheap 5V power supply for the lights
- 3.3V - 5V level converter

Software

I wanted to try and write as little code as possible for this project. I have a Grist instance setup from a previous project, as well as Node-RED and a Mosquitto instance for MQTT so decided I would try to leverage all these low-code tools as much as possible (obviously for the pi itself I would need to write some minimal code consuming from MQTT and controlling the Neopixels).

No-Code

Embedded

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